Carthage

Carthage was a Phoenician city-state that included the Carthaginian Empire between the 7th and 3rd century BCE. It was located on the north coast of Africa and was founded by the Phoenicians of Tyre in 814 BC. The Phoenicians selected this geographical spot for several reasons. First of all, the quality of its harbor and its proximity to trading routes was incredibly convenient. Secondly, the landscape of this place was ideal because the city was built on a triangular peninsula covered with small hills and backed by a lake. Finally, Carthage had easy access to the Mediterranean, was shielded from the violent storms on the coasts and could be easily defended.

Carthaginians were also known as the Punic people. The interests of these people were economic and commercial whereas other cities of the ancient world tended to focus more on the arts and architecture. As a result, there has not been much Punic literature, libraries or archives found over the years that followed the destruction of the Carthaginian Empire. Furthermore, Carthage controlled most of the expensive part of the Western trade. Later in Roman times, Punic elements such as furniture were considered extravagant and were often copied by the people. The richness of Carthage came mainly from the exploitation of silver mines in North Africa, which were created when the city was founded. During this early time, the Carthaginian territory suffered from the Sicilian wars, the Pyrrhic War, and the Punic wars.

After its foundation, Carthage enjoyed considerable economic success due to its trade and this resulted in the construction of a powerful navy. The Phoenicians' growth in power initiated a conflict with the Greeks located in Syracuse because they also wanted to control the Mediterranean Sea and its trade. Therefore, Sicily became an area of struggle. Both empires wanted to use the island for economic and political growth. The Greeks and the Phoenicians had already established colonies in the territory and were constantly fighting each other. The first Sicilian war occurred in 480 BC when Gelo the Athenian leader of Syracuse attempted to force the island under his rule. Carthage lost the war because there was corruption among